

A2F PARTNERS LIMITED

Venture Builder · Institutional Advisory · Capital Infrastructure

RC 9538221 · 16 Idowu Martins Street, Victoria Island, Lagos, Nigeria

ORIGINATION PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Rating-ready SME and mid-corporate debt flow into Agosto & Co.

To	Agusto & Co. Limited, UBA House (5th Floor), 57 Marina, Lagos — via info@agusto.com
Attention	Mrs Yinka Adelekan — Managing Director, Agusto & Co. Limited
From	Dayo Akin, Founder & Managing Partner, A2F Partners Limited
Date	5 August 2026
Reference	A2F/AGU/2026/01
Subject	Structured origination channel for rating-ready SME and mid-corporate issuers

1. Purpose

This memorandum proposes a defined origination channel between A2F Partners Limited and Agosto & Co. Limited, under which A2F assembles and submits rating-ready credit files on behalf of Nigerian SME and mid-corporate issuers seeking indicative and final ratings for short-term and structured debt instruments.

It is submitted for written consideration. No response deadline is implied and no commercial commitment is sought at this stage.

We note Agosto & Co.'s announced partnership with S&P Global and the expansion it signals for pan-African ratings coverage. This proposal stands independently of that transaction and does not rely on it. **A2F makes no representation that any Agosto rating carries international-scale equivalence.**

2. About A2F Partners Limited

A2F Partners Limited (RC 9538221) is a Lagos-based venture builder and institutional advisory firm. The firm operates a portfolio of operating companies alongside an advisory practice that structures capital-raising mandates for Nigerian SMEs and mid-corporates.

A2F's relevant capability for this proposal is origination and information assembly: identifying issuers with genuine debt capacity, working through their financial and governance documentation, and presenting a complete, internally consistent credit file to the parties who rate, arrange and place the instrument.

3. The constraint this addresses

Rating agencies operating in the Nigerian SME and mid-corporate segment face a recurring problem that is not analytical but informational. Issuers in this segment arrive at the rating process with incomplete or inconsistent files. The consequences are familiar:

- Management accounts that do not reconcile to the audited financial statements, requiring several rounds of correspondence before analysis can begin.
- Related-party exposures, contingent liabilities and off-balance-sheet obligations that surface late in the process rather than at intake.
- Governance and board documentation assembled reactively, in response to analyst queries, rather than presented at the outset.

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- Issuers who begin the process without having established that they meet the threshold conditions for a rating worth publishing — consuming analyst time that produces no engagement.

Each of these lengthens turnaround, absorbs analyst capacity that would otherwise be applied to substantive credit judgement, and depresses the conversion rate from enquiry to completed rating. The constraint sits upstream of the agency, in the quality of what arrives.

4. What A2F proposes to deliver

A2F proposes to act as a structured origination layer that presents pre-assembled issuers to Augusto & Co. Each file submitted through this channel would be prepared to a standard agreed in advance with your team, comprising:

1. Audited financial statements for the required look-back period, with management accounts reconciled to them and the reconciliation shown.
2. A completed information pack mapped to the disclosure requirements of the applicable Augusto rating methodology, prepared against your published methodology documents.
3. A disclosed schedule of related-party transactions, contingent liabilities, guarantees and off-balance-sheet obligations, prepared at intake rather than on request.
4. Corporate and governance documentation: constitutional documents, board composition, minutes of the resolutions authorising the issuance, and shareholding structure.
5. Where the instrument is asset-backed or otherwise structured, the transaction documents and a written description of the cash-flow waterfall and security arrangements.
6. A single named A2F contact per file, responsible for responding to analyst queries within an agreed window.

A2F additionally proposes to apply an **internal pre-screen** before any file is submitted, so that issuers who do not meet the threshold conditions for a viable rating are filtered out at A2F's cost rather than at yours. The screening criteria would be set by reference to your published methodologies and refined against your feedback over the first cohort.

5. Proposed operating protocol

A2F suggests the arrangement begin as a limited, unpriced pilot so that both parties can assess file quality against real submissions before any commercial terms are discussed.

Stage 1	Agusto & Co. confirms the file standard, the disclosure schedule and the intake route. A2F prepares against that standard.
Stage 2	A2F submits an initial cohort of files. Agusto assesses them on quality alone and returns written feedback on what was complete and what was not.
Stage 3	A2F revises its intake template against that feedback. Both parties then decide whether to formalise the channel, and on what terms.

All correspondence can be conducted in writing. A2F does not require meetings to operate this process and will work to whatever intake format your team already uses.

6. Scope and boundaries

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So that the proposal is not misread, A2F sets out clearly what it does not do under this arrangement:

- **A2F does not arrange, underwrite, issue, deal in or place securities.** Those functions sit with the licensed Capital Market Operators appointed to each transaction, and A2F works alongside them rather than in place of them.
- **A2F does not participate in, influence or comment on the rating opinion.** The rating committee's independence is the value of the rating; A2F's role ends at the delivery of a complete and accurate file.
- **A2F does not represent Agosto & Co. to issuers.** A2F would make no statement about likely rating outcomes, timelines or fees other than what your team has confirmed in writing.
- **A2F makes no claim as to international-scale equivalence of any national-scale rating,** in this document or in any issuer-facing material.

7. What A2F is asking for

A single written response confirming, or declining, the following:

1. Whether Agosto & Co. would receive files through a defined origination channel of this kind.
2. If so, the intake specification you would want files prepared against, and the correspondence address for submissions.
3. Any constraint — regulatory, methodological or commercial — that would make the arrangement unworkable as described, so that A2F can either address it or withdraw the proposal.

If the answer is no, that is a useful answer and no further correspondence will follow.

Yours faithfully,

Dayo Akin

Founder & Managing Partner

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A2F Partners makes no use of illustrative or unverified figures in issuer- or counterparty-facing documents.